

Before You Vote: A Take-Home Checklist

Six checks you can run on any candidate, in any race, using free public records.

1. Read the conflict-of-interest form, then check it

- Legislative and school board forms: disclosures.utah.gov. County forms: weberelections.gov.
- Search the candidate's name at businessregistration.utah.gov.
- Compare with their own bio, website, and posts. Do the boards and businesses match?
- Does the form match the registry and their own bio? Look for "n/a" where the record shows a business.

2. Follow the money

- Legislative races: disclosures.utah.gov. County races: weberelections.gov/financialdisclosures.
- People or organizations? Local or outside? Money right after a primary?
- Look up any PAC's own report: who runs it, and where its money came from.

3. Look for a record from before the campaign

- Meeting minutes and votes, hearing comments, letters to the editor, past board service.

4. Map the boards and roles

- Which boards do they sit on, and who appointed them?
- Do those boards come before the body they want to join? Will they step aside?

5. Compare what they say with what the record shows

- Treat a candidate's description of their own record as a claim until it matches minutes or filings.

6. Ask the five questions

- **Power:** Will you add a check on decisions the public has no say over?
- **Transparency:** Will you disclose conflicts in writing and out loud before votes?
- **Financial accountability:** On TIF, PIDs, and no-bid contracts — who pays, and will you show the numbers?
- **Environmental impact:** Do water, wetlands, and open space count as a real limit?
- **Community impact:** Who bears the cost of growth, and do residents get real standing?

Ask the people who receive the forms

- Legislative forms go to the Lieutenant Governor's Office (disclosures.utah.gov). Ask who reviews a form when the business registry shows roles that aren't on it.
- County forms go to Weber County Elections: 801-399-8034, elections@weberelections.gov. State law (Utah Code §17-70-304) says a county candidate's form must have a section for each item and be posted online. Ask them to post every candidate's form in one place.
- Ask for clearer questions: relatives in Utah politics or lobbying, relatives doing business with the government, and whether each item comes before that body.

Cautions

- Check the date on everything — board lists and websites go stale.
- Not finding a record is not proof it doesn't exist. Look at the actual page.
- Social media is a lead, not a source.

Where to look

weberelections.gov — dates, vote centers, county filings
disclosures.utah.gov — legislative money and forms
businessregistration.utah.gov
vote.utah.gov · judges.utah.gov · fec.gov
Hive case files:
weber-county-hive.github.io/candidates2026

Weber voting dates

Oct. 13 — ballots mailed; 25 drop boxes open
Oct. 27–30 — early voting, noon–6 p.m., Weber Center, 2380 Washington Blvd.
Nov. 3 — 7 a.m.–8 p.m., Fairgrounds Exhibit Hall or Ogden Valley Library. Drop boxes close 8 p.m.